

Use-Case Flow Specification

Remote Team Time-Tracking & Project Approver (Problem Statement #46)

Use Case ID / Name	UC-04: Review & Approve Timesheet
Primary Actor	Engineering Manager
Secondary Actor	Remote Developer (gets notified once it's decided)
Trigger	A Remote Developer submits a timesheet for approval (UC-03).

Preconditions

- The Engineering Manager is logged in and has approver rights on the project.
- There's a timesheet sitting in "Pending Approval" status, submitted by one of their developers.
- That timesheet has already cleared the 24-hour-per-day check from FR-001, so it's not sitting there because of a data entry error.

Postconditions (Success)

- Timesheet status flips to "Approved."
- Those hours now count toward the project's budget burn rate (FR-004).
- The developer gets a notification letting them know it went through.

Main Success Scenario

1. The manager opens the "Pending Approvals" queue from their dashboard.
2. The system lists out the submitted timesheets – developer name, which project, hours broken down by task, and the total.
3. The manager clicks into one to review it.
4. The system pulls up the full timesheet, including hours per Jira task and any comments left on it from earlier rounds.
5. The manager checks the hours against the linked Jira tickets and where the project stands budget-wise.
6. The manager hits "Approve."
7. The system marks it "Approved" and stamps it with the time.
8. The system folds those hours into the project's burn-rate number and refreshes the dashboard – within 500 ms, per NFR-001.
9. The system lets the developer know their timesheet was approved.
10. That's the end of the use case – nothing more to do here.

Alternate Flow — 6a: Timesheet Gets Rejected Instead

- 6a1. Back at step 6, instead of approving, the manager clicks "Reject."
- 6a2. The system won't let the rejection go through without a comment explaining why (this ties back to FR-002).
- 6a3. Status changes to "Rejected," and the manager's comment gets saved with it.
- 6a4. The developer is notified and can see exactly what the manager wrote.
- 6a5. The developer fixes the timesheet and resubmits, which sends things back to UC-03 (Submit Timesheet for Approval).
- The use case ends here, on the rejected path.

Exception Flow — 5a: Hours Don't Match Up with Jira

- 5a1. If the logged hours don't line up with any ticket actually assigned to the developer (see UC-02), the system flags that entry.
- 5a2. The manager can reach out to the developer for clarification before deciding whether to approve or reject.